

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction

Hepatitis A and Hepatitis B Vaccination

Havrix, Engerix B and Twinrix, for travel and lifestyle risk

Why this document exists

The hepatitis A and B consultation tool has been in the catalogue and assignable to pharmacies without any signed PGD behind it. It was the only service in the catalogue in that position. A consultation run through it was therefore a supply with nothing authorising it. This document closes that gap. The tool itself was checked against the product SPCs and its product and age logic is correct, so this PGD is written to match the tool rather than the other way round.

What this PGD does NOT cover

These are deliberately out of scope. Each needs serology, specialist oversight or an urgent pathway that a community pharmacy cannot provide, and attempting them under this PGD would be unsafe.

- Occupational hepatitis B vaccination for healthcare workers, laboratory staff or anyone whose employment requires proof of immunity. That pathway requires pre and post vaccination serology and a structured non-responder algorithm. Refer to occupational health.
- Patients with renal failure or on dialysis, who need different products and doses (Fendrix, HBVaxPRO 40 microgram) and mandatory serology. Refer to the renal team.
- Newborns of hepatitis B positive mothers, who need a timed birth dose and often immunoglobulin. This is an antenatal pathway.
- Post-exposure prophylaxis of any kind, including needlestick injury and sexual assault. Twinrix is explicitly not recommended for post-exposure use. Refer the same day to the Health Protection Team or emergency care.
- Management of a known non-responder after a completed hepatitis B course. Refer to the GP or occupational health.
- Post-vaccination serology and its interpretation. Not available in community pharmacy and not required for the routine travel population.

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this service to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPCs for the products they hold, and with Green Book chapters 17 and 18 • All users must be trained to the National Minimum Standards and Core Curriculum for Immunisation Training, and be competent in intramuscular vaccination • All users must be competent in the recognition and immediate management of anaphylaxis, and hold current basic life support training • All users must be able to select the correct product AND the correct strength for the age in front of them, since the paediatric formulations contain half the antigen of the adult ones • All users must be competent in travel risk assessment, including destination, duration and activity • All users must previously have used PGD's to administer

	vaccines • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medicinal products • All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005

Clinical condition or situation to which this PGD applies

PGD Indication	Active immunisation against hepatitis A, hepatitis B, or both, in individuals aged 1 year and over who are at increased risk through travel or lifestyle. Supply and administration under this PGD is a private service.
Inclusion criteria, hepatitis A	• Aged 1 year and over. The vaccines are not licensed below 1 year. • Travel to an area of moderate or high hepatitis A endemicity, which in practice is anywhere outside northern and western Europe, North America, Australia and New Zealand. • Or a non-travel risk factor: chronic liver disease including chronic hepatitis B or C, haemophilia or receipt of plasma derived clotting factors, people who inject drugs, gay and bisexual men and other men who have sex with men, or an occupational risk such as laboratory work or sewage work.
Inclusion criteria, hepatitis B	• Aged 1 year and over under this PGD. • Travel to an area of intermediate or high prevalence together with a risk factor, or a lifestyle risk factor regardless of travel. • Risk factors include: a longer stay or expatriate posting, likelihood of needing medical or dental care abroad, travel for medical treatment, unprotected sex with new partners, injecting drug use, tattooing, piercing or acupuncture where sterility cannot be assured, contact sports, and adopting a child from a higher prevalence country.
Inclusion criteria, both	• Valid informed consent obtained, from a person with parental responsibility where the patient is a child. • The patient understands this is a private service and what it costs. • Sufficient information is available about any previous hepatitis A or B vaccination. • No exclusion criteria present.
Exclusion criteria	• Under 1 year of age. • Confirmed anaphylactic reaction to a previous dose of the same vaccine, or to any component. Havrix and Twinrix contain trace neomycin, so a neomycin allergy excludes them. • Previous hypersensitivity reaction following a hepatitis A or hepatitis B containing vaccine. • Acute severe febrile illness. Postpone until recovered. Minor illness without fever is not a reason to defer. • Any of the situations listed under "What this PGD does NOT cover" above, in particular occupational hepatitis B vaccination, renal patients, and any post-exposure situation. • The patient requires proof of immunity, since serology is out of

	scope.
Cautions	• Pregnancy. Hepatitis A vaccine may be given where clearly indicated. For Twinrix the SPC advises delaying until after delivery unless there is an urgent need to protect the mother against hepatitis B. Where hepatitis B protection is needed in pregnancy, use a monovalent hepatitis B vaccine and document the risk assessment. • Breastfeeding. Excretion in breast milk is unknown. There is no established contraindication; weigh benefit and record the decision. • Immunosuppression, including HIV. The response may be reduced and additional doses may be needed. Where the patient needs to know whether they responded, that requires serology and is outside this PGD. Counsel and refer rather than assuming protection. • Bleeding disorders, thrombocytopenia or anticoagulation. Intramuscular injection can usually still be given using a fine needle, 25G where possible, with firm pressure without rubbing for at least 2 minutes. Deep subcutaneous injection is the fallback, but note the Twinrix SPC warns the subcutaneous route may give a suboptimal response. • Twinrix Paediatric and co-administration. Its SPC states that vaccines other than Cervarix should not be given at the same time. This is stricter than the general Green Book position on inactivated vaccines. Where a child needs other travel vaccines, either separate the visits or record that co-administration was an informed off-label decision. • Latex. The presentations are described as synthetic rubber rather than natural latex, but check the current patient information leaflet for the specific product before reassuring a latex-allergic patient. • A patient presenting too late to complete a course. See the section on late presenters below; do not simply decline.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	• Discuss the reason for exclusion and ensure the patient understands it. • Give risk reduction advice regardless of whether vaccine is given. For hepatitis A this is food and water hygiene; for hepatitis B it is avoiding unprotected sex, unsterile tattooing, piercing and acupuncture, and not sharing needles or razors. • Refer to the GP, occupational health, a travel clinic or the Health Protection Team as appropriate, and make the urgency clear where it is a post-exposure situation. • Document the reason, the advice given and the decision reached.

Details of the medicines

Six products are covered. Selecting the wrong strength for the age is the most likely error, because the paediatric formulations contain half the antigen of the adult ones and the packaging is similar.

Product	Age	Content	Dose	Protects against
Havrix Monodose	16 years and over	Hep A 1440 ELISA units	1.0 mL	Hepatitis A
Havrix Junior Monodose	1 to 15 years	Hep A 720 ELISA units	0.5 mL	Hepatitis A
Engerix B	16 years and over	HBsAg 20 micrograms	1.0 mL	Hepatitis B
Engerix B Paediatric	1 to 15 years	HBsAg 10 micrograms	0.5 mL	Hepatitis B
Twinrix Adult	16 years and over	Hep A 720 EU +	1.0 mL	Both

		HBsAg 20 mcg		
Twinrix Paediatric	1 to 15 years	Hep A 360 EU + HBsAg 10 mcg	0.5 mL	Both

Legal category	POM
Storage	Store at 2°C to 8°C in the original packaging, protected from light. DO NOT FREEZE. A vaccine that has been frozen, or is suspected of having been frozen, must be quarantined, labelled and not administered. Freezing separates the antigen from the aluminium adjuvant, which reduces potency and can increase reactogenicity, and it can crack the syringe. The default is to discard unless the manufacturer confirms otherwise.
Route/method of administration	• Intramuscular injection. Deltoid in older children and adults; anterolateral thigh in infants and young children. • Never into the gluteal muscle, and never intravenously or intradermally: the response is unreliable. • Where another vaccine is given at the same visit, use a separate limb where possible, or sites at least 2.5 cm apart. Record the site of each.

Schedules

Hepatitis A, monovalent (Havrix)

- A single dose gives protection from about 2 to 4 weeks, lasting at least a year.
- A booster at 6 to 12 months after the first dose gives long term protection, at least 20 to 25 years. No further boosters are recommended for immunocompetent adults.
- A late booster still works. If it is given within 5 years of the primary dose the course does not need restarting, and even beyond that a booster is generally effective rather than a reason to start again.

Hepatitis B, monovalent (Engerix B)

- Standard: 0, 1 and 6 months. All ages.
- Accelerated: 0, 1 and 2 months, with a booster at 12 months. All ages.
- Very rapid: 0, 7 and 21 days, with a booster at 12 months. Licensed for 18 years and over only. Use in a 16 or 17 year old is off-label; it may be appropriate where the alternative is no protection, but it must be an explicit decision recorded as such with the patient informed.

Combined hepatitis A and B (Twinrix)

- Twinrix Adult standard: 0, 1 and 6 months.
- Twinrix Adult rapid: 0, 7 and 21 days, with a fourth dose at 12 months. Restrict to 18 years and over under this PGD. The SPC wording and national guidance are not fully aligned on whether 16 and 17 year olds are within licence for this schedule, so the conservative position is taken; a 16 or 17 year old needing rapid protection should be treated as off-label with documented consent, or given the standard schedule.
- Twinrix Paediatric: standard 0, 1 and 6 months only. There is no accelerated or rapid schedule for the paediatric formulation. Do not improvise one.

Interrupted courses

- Resume, do not restart. A longer than recommended gap between doses does not reduce the final antibody level for either the hepatitis A or the hepatitis B component.
- Continue with the same product where possible. Monovalent hepatitis B vaccines from different manufacturers are generally interchangeable if the original is unavailable.

Late presenters, which is most of travel practice

- Hepatitis A can be given up to the day of departure. Some protection develops before antibody is detectable, so a late dose is worth giving.
- Hepatitis B needs more lead time. Even the very rapid schedule gives roughly 65% seroprotection by day 28, rising to about 76% by two months, and only reaches near-complete protection after the 12 month booster.

- For a traveller with too little time, still start the course, arrange completion on return, and be explicit that they will not be fully protected while away. Give risk reduction advice and make sure it is understood rather than just mentioned.

Anaphylaxis and observation

- Adrenaline 1:1000 injection must be immediately available whenever a vaccine is administered under this PGD, together with a written anaphylaxis protocol consistent with current Resuscitation Council UK guidance.
- All staff administering vaccines must be trained in the recognition and immediate management of anaphylaxis and hold current basic life support training.
- The patient should remain on the premises for observation in line with the pharmacy SOP.
- Procedures must be in place to prevent injury from a vasovagal faint.

Adverse effects, records and reporting

Adverse effects	Very common: injection site pain and redness, fatigue, headache, and in children irritability. Common: fever, malaise, injection site swelling or induration, gastrointestinal upset, drowsiness and loss of appetite. Uncommon: dizziness, myalgia, rash, influenza-like illness, vomiting. Rare or very rare: paraesthesia, arthralgia, urticaria, pruritus, lymphadenopathy, chills. Reported post-marketing: anaphylaxis, Guillain-Barre syndrome, convulsions, vasculitis, thrombocytopenia, erythema multiforme and angioedema. Consult the current SPC for the product used.
Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse reactions via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: • that valid informed consent was given, and by whom where the patient is a child • name of individual, address, date of birth and GP with whom the individual is registered • name of healthcare practitioner • destination, departure date and the risk factors that made vaccination appropriate • name and brand of vaccine INCLUDING the strength, batch number and expiry date • date of administration, dose, route and anatomical site used • which schedule was chosen, the dose number, and the date the next dose is due • where an off-label schedule was used, that this was explained and consented to • advice given, including risk reduction advice and advice given if excluded • details of any adverse reaction and the action taken • that the vaccine was administered via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. The individual's GP should be informed.

Patient information

- Give the patient the manufacturer's patient information leaflet.
- Give the schedule in writing, with the date each remaining dose is due, and explain that an incomplete course gives incomplete protection.
- Be explicit about what protection they will and will not have by the time they travel, particularly for hepatitis B on a rapid schedule.
- Give risk reduction advice in every case: food and water hygiene for hepatitis A; avoiding unprotected sex, unsterile tattooing, piercing and acupuncture, and not sharing needles or razors, for hepatitis B.

- Explain that vaccination does not protect against hepatitis C, for which there is no vaccine, and that the same precautions apply.
- Counsel on the common local and systemic reactions and their self-limiting nature.
- Advise them to keep a record of what they were given, including the brand, because it determines how a course is completed elsewhere.

References

- UKHSA. Immunisation against infectious disease, the Green Book, chapter 17, Hepatitis A. Current version.
- UKHSA. Immunisation against infectious disease, the Green Book, chapter 18, Hepatitis B. Current version.
- Summary of Product Characteristics for Havrix Monodose, Havrix Junior Monodose, Engerix B, Engerix B Paediatric, Twinrix Adult and Twinrix Paediatric, current versions, electronic Medicines Compendium.
- NaTHNaC TravelHealthPro. Hepatitis A and hepatitis B factsheets and country information pages.
- National Minimum Standards and Core Curriculum for Immunisation Training.
- Resuscitation Council UK. Emergency treatment of anaphylaxis, current guidance.

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates	

Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature

Valid from date	Expiry date
25/8/26	31/7/27

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the administration of a vaccine.

To be completed by the adopting pharmacy: the first block is signed by that pharmacy's superintendent or clinical lead, and the second by its professional group signatory. Get Real Health signs the authorship block below, not these.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		21/08/2026
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		21/08/2026

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	New PGD. Written because the hepatitis A and B consultation tool was live and assignable with no signed document behind it at all, the only service in the catalogue in that position, meaning every consultation was a supply with nothing authorising it. Found during the catalogue-wide audit of 21 August 2026. The tool was checked against the product SPCs first and its product and age logic is correct, so this document was written to match the tool. Scope deliberately excludes occupational hepatitis B for healthcare workers, renal and dialysis patients, newborns of hepatitis B positive mothers, all post-exposure prophylaxis, non-responder management and post-vaccination serology, because each needs serology access or specialist oversight that a community pharmacy does not have. The rapid Twinrix and Engerix B schedules are restricted to 18 and over: the SPC wording and national guidance are not fully aligned for 16 and 17 year olds, so the conservative reading is taken and off-label use requires documented consent. Twinrix Paediatric is stated as having no rapid schedule, and its SPC restriction on co-administration with vaccines other than Cervarix is flagged, because it conflicts with normal travel clinic practice.	21st August 2026